# JanGyan — Learn Without Limits

## Category 2: Government Services & Citizen Rights

### Module 10 - Smart Citizen Guide

## Module Overview

This handbook is the capstone of your Government Services & Citizen Rights journey with JanGyan. It doesn't introduce a new government scheme or institution — instead, it brings together everything from the previous nine modules into one practical Smart Citizen Guide: how to be a responsible digital citizen, use government services safely, avoid government-related fraud, protect your documents, and build a sustainable daily habit of informed, empowered citizenship.

By the end of this module, you will not need to search anywhere else to navigate India's government services confidently, safely, and for life.

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## Learning Objectives

After completing this module, you will be able to:

- Practise responsible digital citizenship when using government platforms
- Use government services safely, avoiding fake portals and fraudulent agents
- Recognise and avoid the most common government-impersonation frauds
- Protect your identity documents from misuse
- Apply a consolidated checklist covering every major government service category
- Build a sustainable, lifelong habit of informed citizenship

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## Why This Topic Matters

Across this category, you've learned that India runs some of the largest citizen service systems in the world — from Aadhaar's 134 crore holders to UMANG's 1,745 services to Ayushman Bharat's 55 crore beneficiaries. Yet fraudsters specifically target citizens trying to access these very services — fake PAN links, fraudulent "scheme registration" agents, and look-alike government portals remain some of the most common scams reported in India.

> *Reality Check: Nearly every type of fraud covered elsewhere in JanGyan's Cyber Safety category — phishing, fake websites, fraudulent calls — has a government-service-specific version: fake ration card renewal links, fraudulent "PM scheme" registration calls, and fake e-KYC update messages.*

Being a smart citizen means combining everything you've learned — knowledge of your rights, the right service channels, and safe digital habits — into one consistent, lifelong practice.

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## Introduction

This module organises its guidance around four pillars:

- **Responsible Digital Citizenship** — using government platforms thoughtfully and safely

- **Safe Service Usage** — verifying official sources before ever entering personal data
- **Fraud Avoidance** — recognising government-impersonation scams specifically
- **Document & Habit Management** — protecting your documents and building lasting daily habits

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## Fundamental Concepts

### The Four Pillars of Smart Citizenship

| Pillar | What It Means |
|---|---|
| **Informed** | Knowing which government level/authority/portal handles your issue |
| **Safe** | Verifying official sources before sharing any personal data |
| **Respectful** | Engaging with government platforms and staff constructively |
| **Proactive** | Not waiting for problems — checking, renewing, and reviewing regularly |

### Official vs Unofficial: The Core Test

| Signal | Official | Unofficial/Suspicious |
|---|---|---|
| **Domain** | Ends in `.gov.in` or `.nic.in` | Random domains, extra words, hyphens |
| **Fees** | Free or clearly published official fee | Demands unofficial "processing fees" |
| **Contact** | Verified helpline/portal | Unsolicited call/SMS/WhatsApp link |
| **Requests** | Never asks for OTP over call/chat | Asks for OTP, full Aadhaar, or bank PIN |

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## Complete Detailed Explanation

### Part A — Responsible Digital Citizenship

Being a responsible digital citizen means using platforms like DigiLocker, UMANG, and MyGov (Module 3) thoughtfully: keeping your own information accurate, respecting others' privacy on citizen engagement platforms, and never using government portals to submit false information or impersonate someone else — itself an offence under the IT Act.

### Part B — Using Government Services Safely

- Always start from an official portal or app, never a link shared via SMS/WhatsApp
- Bookmark frequently used official sites instead of searching for them each time
- Use strong passwords and enable 2FA on any government account offering it
- Never share the OTP used for Aadhaar, DigiLocker, or e-KYC verification with anyone, including someone claiming to "help"

## Part C — Avoiding Government Frauds

| Fraud Pattern | How It Works | Red Flag |
|---|---|---|
| **Fake Scheme Registration Calls** | Caller claims you're "eligible" for a scheme and asks for a "registration fee" | Legitimate schemes never charge a fee to register |
| **Fake e-KYC/Aadhaar Update Links** | SMS/WhatsApp link claims your Aadhaar/ PAN/ration card will be deactivated | Official updates are done via verified apps/ portals or in-person, not via unsolicited links |
| **Fake Government Job/ Recruitment Offers** | Offers a government job for an upfront "fee" or "training charge" | Genuine government recruitment never charges candidates a fee to be considered |
| **Fake Refund/Subsidy Messages** | Claims a refund or subsidy is pending, asking you to click a link and enter bank details | Real subsidies arrive via Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT), not a link requiring your bank PIN |

Every one of these patterns exploits the same trust: citizens assume a message "about a government scheme" must be genuine. It rarely is, unless it originates from an official portal, app, or in-person office.

## Part D — Document Safety

Recap from Module 2: use masked Aadhaar where possible, never post identity documents publicly, keep DigiLocker as a secure digital backup, and keep a physical/digital list of which documents need periodic renewal (passport, driving licence).

## Part E — Government Service Checklist (Cross-Category Recap)

| Need | Service | Module Reference |
|---|---|---|
| Prove identity | Aadhaar, PAN, Voter ID, Passport | Module 2 |
| Access a service digitally | DigiLocker, UMANG, e-Sign | Module 3 |
| Exercise a right | RTI, Consumer complaint | Module 4 |
| Access welfare | PM-KISAN, PM-JAY, Jan Dhan Yojana | Module 5 |
| Resolve a utility issue | Discom, Jal Jeevan Mission, Rail Madad | Module 6 |
| Handle an emergency | 112, 1930, 1098, 181 | Module 7 |
| File a grievance | CPGRAMS, e-Jagriti, Banking Ombudsman | Module 8 |
| Participate civically | Voter registration, EVM voting | Module 9 |

## Part F — Important Official Websites (Master Directory)

See the consolidated table in "Official Government Website Links" at the end of this handbook — bookmarking these now saves significant time later.

## Part G — Common Citizen Mistakes (Cross-Category Recap)

- Approaching the wrong level of government for an issue (Module 1)
- Posting Aadhaar/PAN copies publicly (Module 2)
- Clicking unofficial links for PAN/Aadhaar "verification" (Module 3)

- Not knowing the difference between Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles (Module 4)
- Assuming a scheme "won't apply to me" without checking (Module 5)
- Contacting the wrong utility department (Module 6)
- Not knowing 112 covers police, fire, and medical emergencies (Module 7)
- Filing a grievance with the wrong system (Module 8)
- Assuming voter registration is automatic (Module 9)

### Part H — Daily Smart Citizen Checklist

The centerpiece of this module — see the full checklist under "Practical Checklist" below, organised by daily, monthly, and as-needed habits.

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## Important Terminologies

| Term | Simple Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Responsible Digital Citizenship** | Using digital government platforms thoughtfully, accurately, and safely |
| **DBT** | Direct Benefit Transfer — the legitimate way subsidies/benefits reach your account |
| **e-KYC** | Electronic identity verification, typically via Aadhaar |
| **Masked Aadhaar** | An Aadhaar copy showing only the last 4 digits |
| **Official Domain** | A verified `.gov.in` or `.nic.in` website address |

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## Step-by-Step Understanding

### How to Verify Any Government Scheme or Service Is Genuine

1. Check whether the claim originates from an official `.gov.in`/`.nic.in` source
2. Search independently for the scheme/service name alongside the relevant ministry
3. Confirm there is no fee requested for registration or "processing," unless officially published
4. Verify through UMANG, MyGov, or the specific ministry's portal before proceeding
5. If still unsure, ask at a Common Service Centre or the relevant department directly

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## Real-Life Indian Examples

*(Widely reported public patterns, described for educational awareness.)*

- **Fake PAN 2.0 "Verification" Messages:** As PAN 2.0 rolled out (Module 2), fraudulent SMS/WhatsApp links claiming "urgent PAN verification required" circulated widely, mimicking the genuine modernisation to trick citizens into clicking malicious links.
- **Fake Scheme Registration Agents:** Across welfare scheme rollouts (Module 5), unofficial "agents" charging money to "guarantee" scheme registration have been a persistent, recurring fraud pattern flagged by multiple state governments.
- **Cross-Category Awareness Payoff:** Citizens who completed both JanGyan categories are equipped to recognise that a "government" call demanding an OTP or fee is almost never genuine — combining cyber safety awareness with government service literacy.

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## Practical Scenarios

**Scenario 1:** You receive a call saying you're "pre-approved" for a government scheme and just need to pay a small verification fee.
*This is a fraud pattern. Genuine schemes never charge a fee for registration or approval — verify independently via the scheme's official portal.*

**Scenario 2:** A WhatsApp message says your Aadhaar will be deactivated unless you click a link within 24 hours.
*Ignore the link. Check your Aadhaar status directly via uidai.gov.in or the mAadhaar app instead.*

**Scenario 3:** You want to check if you're eligible for a welfare scheme you heard about from a neighbour.
*Verify directly on the scheme's official portal or via UMANG, rather than relying on word-of-mouth or unofficial sources.*

**Scenario 4:** You're setting up your first DigiLocker account and want to do it safely.
*Download the app only from the official app store listing, verify the publisher is MeitY/NeGD, and never share the OTP used to register.*

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## Government Rules / Guidelines

- **MeitY / NeGD:** Maintain the core digital platforms (DigiLocker, UMANG, MyGov) referenced throughout this category.
- **CERT-In:** Issues advisories when fake government-scheme scams or look-alike portals are identified at scale.
- **Respective Ministries:** Each scheme/service ultimately traces back to a specific ministry's official portal — the single most reliable verification point.

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## Laws & Policies

This capstone module draws on laws detailed fully in earlier modules of this category:

| Law / Provision | Covered In |
|---|---|
| Aadhaar Act, 2016 | Module 2 |
| IT Act, 2000 (Sections 66C, 66D) | Modules 2, 3, 8 |
| Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 | Modules 2, 3 |
| Consumer Protection Act, 2019 | Modules 4, 8 |
| RTI Act, 2005 | Modules 4, 8 |

## Important Statistics

| Metric | Figure |
|---|---|
| Aadhaar holders (recap, Module 2) | ~134 crore |
| UMANG services available (recap, Module 3) | 1,745 |
| RTI applications filed since 2005 (recap, Module 4) | Over 2.5 crore |
| Ayushman Bharat beneficiaries (recap, Module 5) | Over 55 crore |
| Police stations on CCTNS (recap, Module 8) | 17,792 |
| Registered voters (recap, Module 9) | Over 900 million |

*(Figures are cross-referenced from earlier modules in this category and official government sources through 2025–2026.)*

## Best Practices

- Treat every government-related message with the same scepticism you'd apply to any unsolicited offer
- Bookmark official portals rather than searching for them each time
- Never share OTPs, Aadhaar numbers in full, or bank details based on an unsolicited call or link
- Review your key documents and registrations periodically, not just when a problem arises
- Approach the correct government level/authority the first time, using what you learned in Module 1

## Common Mistakes

- Trusting a message simply because it "sounds official" or references a real scheme name
- Paying any fee to an "agent" for a free government service

- Not verifying a portal's domain before entering personal information
- Letting document renewals lapse until an emergency forces urgent action
- Giving up on a legitimate grievance instead of using the systems covered in Module 8

## Myths vs Facts

| Myth | Fact |
|---|---|
| "A message mentioning a real scheme name must be genuine" | Fraudsters deliberately reference real scheme names to appear credible |
| "Government services always require an agent or middleman" | Most services are designed for direct citizen access via official portals |
| "If a portal looks professional, it's official" | Only the exact `.gov.in`/`.nic.in` domain confirms authenticity |
| "Once I've set up a service, I never need to check it again" | Periodic review (documents, registrations, eligibility) prevents future problems |

## Do's and Don'ts

| Do | Don't |
|---|---|
| Verify domains and scheme details independently | Don't trust unsolicited calls/links referencing government schemes |
| Use official apps/portals for every service | Don't pay unofficial agents for free services |
| Keep documents and registrations updated | Don't wait for a crisis to check document validity |
| Apply the correct government level from Module 1 | Don't escalate prematurely to the wrong authority |
| Use the grievance systems from Module 8 when needed | Don't give up after one unresolved attempt |

## Safety Tips

**For Everyday Government Interactions**
- Always verify domains and never click unsolicited scheme/service links
- Never share OTPs, even to someone claiming to represent a government office

**For Documents**
- Use masked Aadhaar and DigiLocker backups as your default habit
- Keep a personal renewal calendar for passport, driving licence, and other time-bound documents

**For Families**
- Teach elderly or less tech-familiar family members the "always verify the domain" rule
- Review scheme eligibility and document status together periodically as a family

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## Practical Checklist

**Daily**
- [ ] Treat unsolicited "government" calls/messages with scepticism
- [ ] Never share OTPs, full Aadhaar numbers, or bank PINs based on a call or link

**Monthly**
- [ ] Check document validity (passport, licence) against upcoming travel/renewal needs
- [ ] Review any pending grievances or applications for status updates

**As-Needed**
- [ ] Verify any new scheme/service claim via its official portal before acting
- [ ] Use CPGRAMS/e-Jagriti/RTI/cybercrime.gov.in as appropriate if something goes wrong
- [ ] Report fraudulent government-impersonation attempts to cybercrime.gov.in or 1930

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## Quick Revision Notes

- Smart citizenship = informed + safe + respectful + proactive
- The `.gov.in`/`.nic.in` domain test is your fastest fraud check
- Genuine schemes never charge registration/processing fees
- Document safety (masked Aadhaar, DigiLocker) applies across every service you use
- Every category module maps to a specific official channel — know which one applies

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## Key Takeaways

1. Fraud targeting government services follows the same patterns as general cyber fraud — verify before trusting
2. The domain check (`.gov.in`/`.nic.in`) is the single fastest way to confirm authenticity
3. No genuine government service ever requires an OTP shared with a stranger or an unofficial fee
4. Reviewing documents and registrations proactively prevents future emergencies
5. This module, paired with the other nine, gives you a complete, lifelong toolkit for navigating Indian government services

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## Glossary

- **DBT** — Direct Benefit Transfer
- **e-KYC** — Electronic identity verification
- **Masked Aadhaar** — An Aadhaar copy showing only the last 4 digits
- **Official Domain** — A verified `.gov.in`/`.nic.in` website address
- **Responsible Digital Citizenship** — Using government platforms thoughtfully, accurately, and safely

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## Frequently Asked Questions

**1. What is responsible digital citizenship?**
Using government platforms thoughtfully, keeping information accurate, and never misusing or impersonating others online.

**2. How can I quickly check if a government website is genuine?**
Verify it ends in `.gov.in` or `.nic.in`.

**3. Do genuine government schemes ever charge a registration fee?**
No — legitimate schemes do not charge citizens to register or be considered eligible.

**4. Is it safe to click a link claiming my Aadhaar will be deactivated?**
No — verify your Aadhaar status directly via uidai.gov.in or the mAadhaar app instead.

**5. What is masked Aadhaar?**
An Aadhaar copy showing only the last 4 digits, for safer physical sharing.

**6. Should I ever share an OTP with someone claiming to help me with a government service?**
No, never — not even someone claiming to be an official.

**7. What should I do if I suspect a government-scheme scam?**
Report it to cybercrime.gov.in or call 1930.

**8. Are all subsidies delivered the same way?**
Most are delivered via Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) directly into your Aadhaar-seeded account, not through a link requiring your bank PIN.

**9. What's the fastest way to check scheme eligibility safely?**
Visit the scheme's official portal or check via UMANG.

**10. Do I need an agent to apply for government services?**
No — most services are designed for direct citizen access via official portals or Common Service Centres.

**11. How often should I review my documents?**
Periodically — at least checking renewal dates well before passport/licence expiry.

**12. What is DigiLocker's role in document safety?**
It provides a secure, officially recognised digital backup of your key documents.

**13. Can fraudsters reference real scheme names to seem credible?**
Yes — this is a common tactic, so the scheme name alone doesn't confirm legitimacy.

**14. What is the single fastest fraud-check for any government service?**
Verifying the exact domain is `.gov.in`/`.nic.in`.

**15. What should I do if a grievance goes unresolved?**
Use the appeal mechanisms covered in Module 8 (CPGRAMS, e-Jagriti, RTI appeals, Banking Ombudsman appeal).

**16. Is it normal for government recruitment to charge a "training fee"?**
No — genuine government recruitment never charges candidates a fee to be considered.

**17. How do I know which government level handles my issue?**
Refer to Module 1's framework: local for civic issues, state for police/health, central for passports/taxes.

**18. Should I trust a call just because it shows a government-sounding number?**
No — caller ID can be spoofed; always verify independently.

**19. What's the best habit for avoiding government-related fraud long-term?**
Applying the same scepticism and verification habits taught throughout JanGyan's Cyber Safety category.

**20. Can I check multiple government services in one place?**
Yes — UMANG aggregates many services, and MyGov/India.gov.in provide broader navigation.

**21. What should families do together for smart citizenship?**
Review document status, scheme eligibility, and safe verification habits together periodically.

**22. What is the ultimate goal of this module?**
To combine everything learned in this category into one safe, sustainable, lifelong citizenship practice.

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## Suggested Infographics, Flowcharts & Illustrations

*(For JanGyan design team — placement suggestions only; no images generated here)*

- **"Four Pillars of Smart Citizenship" wheel** → within "Fundamental Concepts"
- **Official vs Unofficial verification checklist card** → within "Fundamental Concepts"
- **Government fraud patterns comparison table graphic** → within "Complete Detailed Explanation, Part C"
- **Master official-websites directory poster** → within "Official Government Website Links"
- **Cross-category "Which Module Covers This?" navigation chart** → near "Practical Checklist"

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## Official References


- Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) — digital platform and citizen safety guidance
- Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) — advisories on government-impersonation scams
- JanGyan Modules 1–9 — Government Services & Citizen Rights category (source material consolidated in this handbook)
- JanGyan Cyber Safety & Digital Security category — cross-referenced fraud-avoidance principles


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## Official Government Website Links

**Identity & Documents**
- UIDAI (Aadhaar): **https://uidai.gov.in**
- Income Tax e-Filing (PAN): **https://www.incometax.gov.in**
- Passport Seva: **https://www.passportindia.gov.in**
- Parivahan (Driving Licence): **https://parivahan.gov.in**

**Digital Services**
- DigiLocker: **https://www.digilocker.gov.in**
- UMANG: **https://web.umang.gov.in**
- MyGov: **https://www.mygov.in**

**Rights & Grievances**
- RTI Online: **https://rtionline.gov.in**
- CPGRAMS: **https://pgportal.gov.in**
- National Consumer Helpline / e-Jagriti: **https://consumerhelpline.gov.in**
- RBI Complaint Management System: **https://cms.rbi.org.in**

**Welfare & Services**
- Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY: **https://pmjay.gov.in**
- PM-KISAN: **https://pmkisan.gov.in**
- PM Jan Dhan Yojana: **https://pmjdy.gov.in**

**Safety & Emergency**
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: **https://cybercrime.gov.in**
- 112 India (ERSS): **https://112.gov.in**
- Digital Police Portal (CCTNS): **https://digitalpolice.gov.in**

**Civic Participation**
- Election Commission of India: **https://www.eci.gov.in**
- National Voters' Service Portal: **https://voters.eci.gov.in**

**General**
- India.gov.in (National Portal): **https://www.india.gov.in**

**Key Helplines:** Emergency: **112** | Cybercrime: **1930** | Child: **1098** | Women: **181**

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## Conclusion

Congratulations on completing the full **Government Services & Citizen Rights** category. Across ten modules, you've learned how India's government is structured, how to secure and use your essential documents, how to access services digitally, what rights and duties you hold, which welfare schemes exist, how utilities work, who to call in an emergency, how to file and escalate a grievance, how elections function, and now — how to bring it all together safely and sustainably as a smart citizen.

Government services exist to serve you — but only if you know how to find them, verify them, and use them safely. This handbook, alongside the nine before it, is designed to make sure you always do.

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*Module 10 of the Government Services & Citizen Rights Category*